

INSTITUTE FOR CHRISTIAN STUDIES

A photograph of a panel discussion on a church stage. Three people are seated in wooden chairs: a woman on the left, a man in the center, and a woman on the right. They are facing each other in conversation. Behind them is a white altar with a wooden table holding a plant and a pitcher. A large organ is visible in the background. In the foreground, the backs of many audience members' heads are visible as they sit in pews, looking towards the stage.

Free *to be* Faithful

Equipping Christians for Democratic Life.

2025 — 2026 SEASON

Finding a Better Way.

Launched by the **Institute for Christian Studies (ICS)**, Free to be Faithful is a **program**, a **resource**, and a **community**, designed to help Christians meet our complex moment.

Our courses, community, and events develop believers who are both **faithfully Christian** and **deeply committed to the common good** in our divided age.

*Rooted without becoming rigid.
Bold without becoming belligerent.
Faithful without becoming fearful.*



"For freedom Christ has set us free. Stand firm, therefore, and do not submit again to a yoke of slavery."

GALATIANS 5 : 1

Program • Resource • Community.

Three ways F2BF helps you connect faith and life.

01 Program

Six-week online seminars led by world-class scholars, with the option to earn ICS credit toward degree completion.

- Courses to foster deeper understanding
 - Retreats and intensives for all walks
 - Pathways toward a Master of Worldview Studies
-

02 Resource

Curated texts, essays, and dialogues on the issues facing Christians today, gathered, framed, and made shareable.

- Curated texts to dive deeper
 - Shared expertise from scholars
 - Enriching dialogues to relive or discover
-

03 Community

Open events, coalitions, and conversations with welcoming people from every Christian tradition.

- Open events to strengthen coalitions
- Timely writing to challenge and inform
- Welcoming people from every tradition

A YEAR OF FREE TO BE FAITHFUL

Where we've been— *since May 2025.*

MAY 2025 • LAUNCH GATHERING

Free to be Faithful

GRAND RAPIDS

MAY 2025

Faithful Interpretation & Questions of Sexuality

SYLVIA KEESMAAT & LEN VANDER ZEE

JULY 2025

Summer Big Read

BRUCE BERGLUND WITH KRISTIN KOBES DU MEZ

SEPTEMBER 2025

Gender, Sexuality, and the Bible

WITH SYLVIA KEESMAAT

SEPTEMBER 2025

Twentieth Century Authoritarianism

WITH BRUCE BERGLUND

SEPTEMBER 2025

Fall Big Read

HANNA REICHEL & KRISTIN KOBES DU MEZ

OCTOBER 2025

Reechanting the World Conference

OCTOBER 2025

The Good, the True, the Beautiful

WITH KAREN SWALLOW PRIOR

— AND WHERE WE'RE GOING.

The road ahead— *through 2026.*

JANUARY 2026

Reading the Ruins

WITH ANGELA REITSMA BICK

MARCH 2026

The Christian-Jewish Question Today

WITH MATTHEW D. TAYLOR

MARCH 2026

The Evangelical Imagination

WITH KAREN SWALLOW PRIOR

MAY 2026

Courageous Faith in a Time of Fear

TORONTO • PUBLIC CONFERENCE

JUNE 2026

The Contemplative Life in the Age of Distraction

WITH JACOB BENJAMINS

● COURSE

● EVENT

VOICES OF THE YEAR

The people shaping the *conversation*.

Scholars, writers, and pastoral voices guiding our courses and gatherings.



Sylvia Keesmaat

SCHOLAR · ACTIVIST ·
SPEAKER



Bruce Berglund

AUTHOR · HISTORIAN



**Karen Swallow
Prior**

AUTHOR · BETHEL
SEMINARY



Hanna Reichel

THEOLOGIAN ·
PRINCETON



**Kristin Kobes Du
Mez**

HISTORIAN · CALVIN
UNIVERSITY



**Angela Reitsma
Bick**

FORMER EDITOR IN CHIEF
· CHRISTIAN COURIER



Matthew D. Taylor

SCHOLAR & AUTHOR



Jacob Benjamins

POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW ·
ICS



Ron Kuipers

PRESIDENT · ICS



Joash P. Thomas

PUBLIC THEOLOGIAN · ST.
STEPHEN'S



Gideon Strauss

PHILOSOPHER · ICS



Brian Walsh

THEOLOGIAN & AUTHOR

JOIN THE MOVEMENT

Embrace Your *Freedom* to Be Faithful.

Join a growing community of Christians who believe that ancient faith can actively engage the pressing issues of our time.

Whether you're seeking deeper study, curated reading, or simply a circle of welcoming people, there is a way in for you.

01 Explore the courses.

f2bf.icscanada.edu/f2bf-courses

02 Subscribe on Substack.

instituteforchristianstudies.substack.com

03 Support the work.

icscanada.edu/donate

Start here.

Scan to visit Free to be Faithful and find the next course, resource, or gathering for you.



FOR FREEDOM CHRIST HAS SET US FREE.

Free *to be* Faithful

Rooted without becoming rigid. Bold without becoming belligerent. Faithful without becoming fearful.

BEGIN HERE

f2bf.icscanada.edu

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A lifelong learning initiative of the Institute for Christian Studies — a graduate school in the Reformational tradition affiliated with the University of Toronto.

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